# User Manual: Desktop

**The Intelligence Forge Lab: Paper Tracker**

🌐 **Language:** English · বাংলা

This manual explains how to use the Paper Tracker on a **computer** (laptop or desktop) in a web browser such as Chrome, Edge or Firefox. Members should read sections 1–12. Admins should also read section 13.

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# 1. The screen at a glance

The screen has two fixed parts: a **sidebar** on the left and a **top bar**.

**Sidebar:** click any item to open that page.

| Item | What it is for |
|---|---|
| **Dashboard** | Your home page: your numbers, goals, deadlines and what the lab is reading |
| **My Papers** | Every paper you have logged |
| **Progress** | Goals people in the lab are working towards, with progress updates |
| **Messages** | Chat with members one-to-one or in groups. A red number shows unread messages. |
| **Deadlines** | Conference and journal deadlines, with countdowns |
| **Explore** | Search all papers in the lab |
| **Members** | Everyone in the lab and what they read |
| **Topics** | Research topics, each with its papers and readers |
| **Activity** | The latest papers and plans across the lab |
| **Lab Stats** | Charts for the whole lab |
| **Admin** / **Manage users** | Admins only. Hidden for members. |

**Top bar (top right):**

- 🔔 **Bell:** unread messages and deadlines due in the next 7 days. Admins also see password requests here. A red number shows how many items there are. The bell also has **Turn on desktop notifications** (see section 11).
- ☾ / ☀**:** switches between dark and light mode.
- **Your photo or initials:** opens a menu with **Profile & settings**, **Change password** and **Sign out**.

## 2. Signing in for the first time

Your admin creates your account and sends you a **username** (for example `Rahim.IFL.03`) and a **temporary password**.

1. Open the lab's website address in your browser.
2. Type your **username** and **temporary password**, then click **Sign in**.
3. You are asked to choose a **new password**. It needs **at least 8 characters**, with both **letters and numbers**. Type it twice and save.
4. You land on the **Dashboard**.

> **Tip:** sign in with your username, not an email address.

## 3. Forgot your password

1. On the sign-in page, click **Forgot password?**, next to the Password field.
2. Enter your **username** and, if you like, a short note. Then click **Send request**.
3. Your admin is notified. They will send you a new temporary password.
4. Sign in with it, then choose your own password again.

To **change** your password while signed in, click your photo (top right) and choose **Change password**. Enter your current password, then the new one twice.

## 4. Your profile

Click your photo (top right) and choose **Profile & settings**. You can:

- upload a **profile photo**
- change your **full name**
- set your **research area**, for example "Bangla NLP"
- write a short **bio**

Click **Save**. Other members see this on the **Members** page and next to your papers.

> Your **username** can only be changed by an admin.

## 5. The dashboard

The dashboard is your home page. From top to bottom:

### The blue banner

- today's date and a greeting
- a one-line summary of your reading, for example your streak or how many papers you read in the last 30 days
- four numbers:

| Number | Meaning |
|---|---|
| **Papers read** | Papers with status **Completed** |
| **In progress** | Papers with status **Reading** |
| **Streak** | Days in a row on which you read a paper, counted by each paper's **Date read**. The best streak is shown underneath. |
| **Time reading** | Total hours you logged as "Time spent" |

- **Log paper** button. Admins also see **Add member**.

**Quick actions:** four shortcuts: **Log a paper**, **Research topics**, **Lab progress** and **Explore papers**.

**Get started:** a checklist for new members. It disappears once every step is done.

1. Log your first paper
2. Tag it with a research topic
3. Write the novelty and research gap, or upload an analysis PDF
4. Start a preparation
5. Add a profile photo

Click any step to go straight to the right page.

**My reading:** two charts, papers per month and your topics. They appear after you log your first paper.

**My preparations:** your active goals. Click **New** to add one.

**Recently logged:** your four newest papers.

### Right-hand column

- **Next deadlines:** the three nearest conference or journal deadlines, with a countdown and the poster thumbnail. **+ Add** adds a new venue (see section 9).
- **Lab pulse:** papers logged by the whole lab in the last 30 days, how many people are reading, and the **trending topics**. Click a topic to open its page.

- **Latest lab updates:** recent progress updates from everyone
- **My submissions:** papers you plan to submit, with their status

# 6. Logging a paper

Click **Log paper** on the dashboard, or **My Papers** → **Add paper**. The form has three parts. Only the **Title** is required.

## Part 1: Bibliographic details

- **Title**, **Authors** (comma-separated), **Year**, **Venue** (conference or journal), **DOI / URL**
- **PDF (optional):** the paper itself, up to **50 MB**

## Part 2: Classification and reading

- **Paper type:** Survey, Empirical, Theoretical, Review, Case study, Dataset or Other
- **Status: To read**, **Reading** or **Completed**
- **Research topics:** start typing to find a topic. If it doesn't exist yet, press **Enter** to create it. A paper can have several topics.
- **Date read**, **How I read it** (full read, skim, abstract only, group discussion), **Time spent** (hours and minutes), **Rating** (1–5 stars)

## Part 3: Notes and analysis

Write your understanding of the paper. Every field is optional.

| Field | What to write |
|---|---|
| **Summary** | What the paper is about, in a few sentences |
| **Novelty** | What is new compared with earlier work |
| **Research gap** | The problem or gap it addresses, and what is still open |
| **Methodology** | How they did it: model, data, experiments |
| **Results** | Main findings and numbers |
| **Key contributions** | The main contributions, in your words |
| **Limitations** | Weak points and assumptions |
| **My notes** | Your own ideas and questions |

**Prefer to write elsewhere?** Under **Analysis as PDF**, upload your notes or review as a PDF (up to 50 MB) instead of typing. The lab can open it from the paper page and the topic page.

Click **Add paper** to save.

## Editing and deleting

Open the paper from **My Papers**, then click **Edit** or **Delete**. Only you can edit your own papers. Admins can delete any paper.

> **Tip:** set **Status = Completed** and fill in **Date read**. Otherwise the paper doesn't count towards your "Papers read", streak or charts.

# 7. Research topics: who reads what

Click **Topics** in the sidebar. Every topic shows how many papers and readers it has.

- Click a topic to expand it. You see who is reading it, the latest papers, and anyone "working on it" in **Progress**.
- Click **Open topic page** for the full view.

## The topic page

**Left: every paper on this topic.** Each card shows:

- the title, authors and venue, plus the status
- **who read it**
- their **Novelty**, **Research gap**, **Methodology** and **Results**. Click **Show more** to read the full text.
- an **Analysis PDF** button, if the reader uploaded one
- **Full notes**, which opens the complete paper page

Use the search box to look inside titles, methods and results.

**Right: "Who's reading this topic".** This lists every member with papers on the topic, with counts for reading and done. **Click a name** to show only that person's papers. Click **Show everyone** to undo.

**Add a paper to this topic** (top right) opens the paper form with this topic already selected.

## 8. Progress: sharing your goals

A **preparation** is something you are working towards, for example learning a topic, writing a paper, running an experiment or preparing for an exam. The whole lab can see it.

1. Open **Progress** and click **New preparation**, or use **New** on the dashboard.
2. Enter a **Title** and **Category**. Optionally add a **research topic**, a **target date**, a starting percentage and a description.
3. As you make progress, open the preparation and click **Post update**. Set the new percentage with the slider or the 10/25/50/75/100% buttons, and write what you did.
4. At **100%** it is marked **Completed** automatically.

Your updates appear on the **Progress** board, on your profile, on the topic's page, in **Activity**, and in **Latest lab updates** on everyone's dashboard.

# 9. Deadlines, submissions and posters

Open **Deadlines**. Venues are sorted by their nearest deadline, with a live countdown:

- 🟢 more than 30 days left
- 🟡 7–30 days left
- 🔴 less than 7 days left
- ⚪ passed

You can:

- switch between **List** and **Calendar**
- filter by upcoming or past, conference or journal, and field
- open a venue to see all its dates: abstract, full paper, notification and camera-ready

**Planning to submit?** Open the venue and click **I'm planning to submit**. Enter your paper title and status (Planning, Writing, Submitted, Accepted or Rejected), and update it as you go. It appears under **My submissions** on your dashboard.

## Adding a conference or journal (with a poster)

1. Click **Add venue** on the Deadlines page, or **+ Add** under *Next deadlines* on the dashboard.
2. Enter the **Name** (for example "BLP 2027"), **Type**, **Field / topic**, **Website** and **Location**.
3. Fill in the dates you know: **Abstract deadline**, **Full paper deadline**, **Notification date** and **Camera-ready date**. Dates are in your own time zone.
4. **Poster / image (optional):** click **Choose image** and pick the conference poster, call-for-papers image or logo (PNG, JPG, WebP or GIF, up to **10 MB**). A preview appears.
5. Add **Notes** if useful (page limit, template link, AoE time…), then click **Add venue**.

The poster appears as a small picture on the deadline cards and large at the top of the venue page. Click it there to open it full size. To change or remove it, open the venue and click **Edit**.

Members can add venues when the admin has switched on **"Members can add conferences & journals"** (it is on by default). You can edit or delete only the venues you added. Admins can edit or delete any venue.

# 10. Messages: chat with the lab

**Messages** works like WhatsApp, inside the lab tracker. Open it from the sidebar.

## The screen

- **Left:** your chats, newest first. Each row shows the last message and its time. Bold text and a blue number mean unread messages. A 🔒 means an admin has blocked that chat.
- **Right:** the open chat. Your messages are on the right in blue; other people's are on the left.

## Start a chat

- **One-to-one:** click the blue **✚ (New chat)** button and pick a person. Admins are listed first. You can also open someone's profile from **Members** and click **Message**.
- **Message an admin:** click **Message an admin** under the search box.
- **Group:** click the **👥 (New group)** button, type a **Group name**, tick the members and click **Create group**. You become the group's **owner**.

## Send messages, images and files

- Type in the box at the bottom and press **Enter** to send. **Shift + Enter** starts a new line. Bangla typing works normally.
- **Paste a screenshot or image:** copy it (for example with the Print Screen key or "Copy image"), click in the message box and press **Ctrl + V**.
- **Drag and drop:** drag files from your computer onto the chat.
- 📎 **Attach:** pick files from your computer.

You can send **images** (PNG, JPG, WebP, GIF), **PDFs**, **Word, Excel and PowerPoint** files, **text/CSV** and **ZIP**, up to **25 MB** each and up to 10 at a time. Files are listed above the box before sending. Click **×** to remove one. Any text you type is sent with the first file.

Images show inside the chat. Click one to open it full size. PDFs and documents show as a file card. Click it to open or download.

## Message options

Hover over a message and click ⋮:

- **Copy text**
- **Open / download** (for files)
- **Delete:** removes **your own** message for everyone. Admins can delete any message.

## Group info

In a group, click ⓘ at the top right to see the members. The **owner** (and admins) can **rename** the group, **Add people** and remove members. Anyone can **Leave group**. If the owner leaves, the longest-standing member becomes the new owner.

> **Privacy:** chats are visible only to their members **and to lab admins**, who can read chats for moderation. Don't share passwords or other secrets in chat.

# 11. Notifications and reminders

### In the app

- The 🔔 **bell** counts unread messages and deadlines in the next 7 days. Click it to see them, then click an item to open it.
- **Messages** in the sidebar shows your unread count.
- When a message arrives while you're on another page, a small pop-up appears at the bottom of the screen with an **Open** button.

**Deadline reminders.** The app reminds you about abstract and full-paper deadlines **7 days, 3 days, 1 day and on the day**. Each reminder is shown once, as a pop-up when you open the app.

**Desktop notifications.** You can also get notifications even when the tab is in the background:

1. Click the 🔔 **bell** and choose **Turn on desktop notifications**.
2. When the browser asks, click **Allow**.

From then on, new messages and deadline reminders appear as notifications from your operating system.

> Desktop notifications work while the Paper Tracker is open in a browser tab. It can be in the background or minimised, but not closed. If you clicked **Block** by mistake, click the 🔒 icon at the left of the address bar, set **Notifications** to **Allow**, and reload.

## 12. Exploring the lab

| Page | How to use it |
| --- | --- |
| **Explore** | Search every paper in the lab. Filter by **topic, type, status, year or member**, and change the sort order. Click a paper to read its notes. |
| **Members** | Everyone in the lab. Click a person to see their profile, numbers, charts and papers. Their papers are read-only for you. |
| **Activity** | A timeline of new papers, submissions and progress updates |
| **Lab Stats** | Lab-wide charts: papers per month, topics, paper types and top readers |

# 13. For admins

Only accounts with the **Admin** role can do the things in this section. Members don't see the **Admin** or **Manage users** links, can't open those pages, and the server rejects their requests.

## 13.1 The admin overview on the dashboard

Admins see an extra row on the dashboard. Click any tile to jump to the admin pages.

| Tile | Meaning |
|---|---|
| **Active members** | Accounts that can sign in |
| **Lab papers** | Every paper logged in the lab |
| **Password requests** | Turns yellow when someone is waiting for a reset |
| **Blocked** | Blocked accounts |

## 13.2 Manage users

Open **Manage users** in the sidebar, or **Admin → Users**.

**At the top:** counts of **Members**, **Active**, **Blocked** and **Awaiting first login** (people who haven't replaced their temporary password yet).

**Search and filters:** search by name, username or research area. Use the **All / Active / Blocked / Admins** buttons to filter.

**Each user's row** has a dot on the photo: 🟢 means active, 🔴 means blocked. It also has these buttons:

| Button | What it does |
|---|---|
| ✏️ **Edit** | Change **full name**, **username**, **research area** and **bio** |
| 🚫 **Block** | Asks for confirmation, then signs the person out and stops them signing in. Their papers stay. The row shows **Blocked**. |
| ✅ **Unblock** | Shown instead of Block for blocked users. Restores sign-in. |
| 🗑️ **Delete** | **Permanently** deletes the account, all their papers, PDFs and submissions. **This cannot be undone.** |
| ⋮ **More** | **Reset password**, **Make admin** / **Make member** |

**Safety rules:**

- You can't block or delete your own account.
- You can't block, delete or demote the **last** admin.
- If you might ever need the person's data again, **Block** instead of Delete.

> **Changing a username:** the person signs in with the **new** username from then on, and their password stays the same. Tell them about the change.

## 13.3 Create a user

1. **Manage users** → **Create user**.
2. Type the **full name**. A username like `Rahim.IFL.04` is suggested, and you can change it.
3. Keep the generated **temporary password** or type one. It needs 8+ characters with letters and numbers.
4. Choose **Member** or **Admin**, and optionally a research area.
5. Click **Create account**. The username and password are shown **once**. Click **Copy** and send them to the person privately.

## 13.4 Password requests

When someone uses **Forgot password?**, the request shows under the 🔔 **bell** and at the top of **Manage users**.

- Click **Reset password**. A new temporary password is shown once. Send it to the person privately, and the request closes automatically.
- Click **Dismiss** to close a request without acting on it.

You can also reset anyone's password at any time from ⋮ → **Reset password**.

## 13.5 Other admin pages

Open **Admin** in the sidebar. The tabs along the top are:

| Tab | Use |
|---|---|
| **Overview** | Lab statistics, and the switch **"Members can add conferences & journals"** |
| **Users** | Same as **Manage users** |
| **Papers** | Search every paper and delete duplicates or mistakes |
| **Topics** | Create, rename, recolour or delete topics. Deleting a topic only removes the tag; papers stay. |
| **Venues** | Add, edit or delete conferences and journals |
| **Chats** | Every chat in the lab: read, block and delete (see 13.6) |

## 13.6 Moderating chats

Open **Admin → Chats**. Every direct chat and group in the lab is listed, with its members, the number of messages and the last activity. Use the search box and the **All / Direct / Groups / Blocked** filters to find one.

| Button | What it does |
|---|---|
| 👁 **View** | Opens the chat so you can read it. Hover a message and use ⋮ → **Delete** to remove it. |
| 🔒 **Block** | Nobody can send new messages in that chat. Members can still read it and see that it is blocked. |
| 🔓 **Unblock** | Allows messages again |
| 🗑️ **Delete** | **Permanently** deletes the chat with all its messages and files, for everyone |

You can do the same from inside any chat you are in, with the ⋮ menu at the top right.

> **Blocking a chat vs. blocking a person:** blocking a chat only stops messages in that chat. To stop someone using the app entirely, block their account in **Manage users** (13.2). A blocked account can't send messages anywhere.

## 14. Common questions

**My charts say "No data yet".** You haven't logged a paper yet. Log one, set **Status = Completed** and fill in **Date read**.

**My streak is 0.** The streak counts days in a row that have a paper with that **Date read**. It must include today or yesterday, and a day with no paper resets it.

**I can't edit someone else's paper.** That's expected. Only the person who logged a paper can edit it.

**A topic I need doesn't exist.** In the paper form, type the topic name in **Research topics** and press **Enter**.

**My PDF won't upload.** Only PDF files up to **50 MB** are accepted.

**I was signed out and can't sign in.** Your account may be blocked, or your password was reset. Contact your lab admin.

**Messages doesn't appear in my sidebar.** Chat hasn't been set up yet. Ask your admin to run the latest database update.

**I can't send messages in a chat.** An admin has blocked that chat (you'll see 🔒 **Blocked**), or you are no longer in the group.

**My file won't send.** Files must be under 25 MB and be an image, PDF, Office document, text/CSV or ZIP.

**I don't get desktop notifications.** Turn them on from the 🔔 bell, and keep the Paper Tracker open in a tab. Check that the browser and your computer's "Do not disturb" mode allow notifications.

**Who can see my papers and notes?** Everyone in the lab who is signed in. Nothing is public on the internet.

*Can't find an answer? Ask your lab admin.*